

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Trump citizenship change blocked

JOHNSON'S FIGHTING WORDS: Promising a “fight” to protect all Chicagoans, Mayor Brandon Johnson said Thursday he has not reached out to the White House in the face of Republican President Donald Trump’s ongoing threats against immigrants — and Democratic officials such as Johnson himself. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

MEDICAID CUTS? House Republicans are considering Medicaid cuts to cover the cost of a massive tax cut to benefit the wealthy and an immigration crackdown bill. **Nation & World**

Order is ‘blatantly unconstitutional,’ says federal judge as DOJ vows to ‘vigorously defend’ decree

By **Gene Johnson and Mike Catalini**
Associated Press

SEATTLE — A federal judge temporarily blocked President Donald Trump’s executive order redefining birthright citizenship, calling it “blatantly unconstitutional” during the first hearing Thursday in a multistate effort challenging the order.

U.S. District Judge John Coughenour repeatedly interrupted a Justice Department lawyer during arguments to ask how he could consider the order constitutional.

When the attorney, Brett Shumate, said he’d like a chance to explain it in a full briefing, Coughenour told him the hearing was his chance.

The temporary restraining order sought by Arizona, Illinois, Oregon and Washington was the first to get a hearing with a judge and applies nationally.

The case is one of five lawsuits being brought by 22 states and a number of immigrants rights groups across the country. The suits include personal testimonies from attorneys general who are

Turn to Trump, Page 4



White House staff secretary Will Scharf talks with President Donald Trump after he signed executive orders on Thursday. **BEN CURTIS/AP**

‘There’s things that are completely out of your control’: Despite precautions, Matteson farm loses entire flock of hens to devastating bird flu outbreak



IN SOUTH SUBURBS, NATURE’S HAVOC

By **Samantha Moilanen**
Daily Southtown
and **Peter Breen**
Chicago Tribune

Farmers at Kakadoodle, a family chicken farm in south suburban Matteson, were in its coops on a recent Sunday because a water pipe had frozen when they discovered about 30 dead birds.

MariKate Thomas, who owns Kakadoodle with her husband, said that at first they thought the deaths were tied to the low temperatures.

“It was right when the weather was shifting,” Thomas said. “It was getting really cold, and so we were just thinking it was the cold weather.”

When they returned to the coops the next day, they found hundreds of dead hens, she said.

When they returned the day after that, hundreds more had died. By Friday night, testing confirmed the hens were dying of bird flu. By the time a team of U.S. Department of Agriculture workers in hazmat gear came out to the

MariKate Thomas, the co-owner of Kakadoodle Farm, walks on the farm in Matteson on Thursday.

All of the farm’s chickens died of avian flu or had to be culled. In the meantime, Thomas and her husband started a GoFundMe on Sunday that had raised over \$15,000 as of Thursday evening. The funds will be used to support Kakadoodle’s online marketplace and pay the farm’s employees, she said.

EILEEN T. MESLAR/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

farm Saturday to kill the remaining hens, only about 500 still were alive, Thomas said. About 2,500 were already gone.

Though the couple did not expect their farm to face an outbreak, they had started taking precautions a few days before the flock was infected, such as giving their hens garlic and apple cider vinegar to help boost their immune systems, Thomas said.

“I was hoping that we wouldn’t get affected by it, but four days later, we were in it,” she said. It’s just mind-numbing, just the whole sequence of events, how quickly it hit us and where we are now with it today.”

Avian influenza, commonly called bird flu, is a viral infection that spreads in birds, cows and other animals, according to the Cleveland Clinic. The hens of the Thomas flock are among the millions of wild and domestic birds that have died over the last two years worldwide.

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Agency’s Six Flags trips face criticism

‘Troubled’ housing authority spent \$60K over three-year span

By **Lizzie Kane**
Chicago Tribune

Riding roller coasters. Chowling down on fried food. Catching waves in the pool at Hurricane Harbor.

Hundreds of Housing Authority of Cook County employees and their families could enjoy these activities and more for three years at Six Flags on the agency’s dime.

The state’s second-largest housing authority, which was flagged by the U.S. Department of Housing and Urban Development as “troubled” in part because of an absentee board, low-grade property inspections, incorrect reporting on leases, high outstanding balances for tenants behind on rent and failure to submit financial reports on time, spent more than \$60,000 on such trips.

The money came out of HACC’s roughly \$22 million annual budget, dollars meant to be spent on providing public and subsidized housing to some of the lowest income residents in the county.

“This wasn’t a frivolous use of taxpayer funds,” said Richard Monocchio, executive director of HACC for 12 years before he took his current job at HUD in May 2023, in an interview with the Tribune. “This was good governance.”

Monocchio was in charge when the Six Flags trips occurred and went on three himself, describing the outings as a reward for his employees to show appreciation for their hard work. The trips were held in lieu of holiday parties that HACC threw in past years at a similar expense, Monocchio said.

The trip to Six Flags saved “major time” and costs in comparison to a winter event,

Turn to Trips, Page 4

A+E ‘Emilia Pérez’ leads Oscar nominations

Hollywood lined up behind the Netflix narco-musical about trans identity “Emilia Pérez” in Oscar nominations announced Thursday, and “Pérez” star Karla Sofía Gascón became the first openly trans actor nominated. Another musical — “Wicked” the smash Broadway adaptation — came away with nearly as many nominations, as the race for best picture seems to be wide-open.

MICHAEL MADIGAN TRIAL

Feds: Powerful speaker was focused on making money

By **Jason Meisner, Megan Crepeau and Ray Long**
Chicago Tribune

In his testimony earlier this month, former House Speaker Michael Madigan cast himself as a champion of the working class, a consensus-builder who used his power to bring people together on legislation and protect constitu-

ents from greedy utilities and corporations.

Federal prosecutors say the speaker had a different goal in mind: The “Make Michael Madigan Money Plan.”

That’s the unflattering phrase coined during flattering arguments Thursday in Madigan’s corruption trial, where prosecutors alleged the once-powerful speaker and leader of the state

Democratic Party schemed for years to line his own pockets, dangling official action to pressure well-heeled developers to hire his private law firm for tax appeal work.

“The ‘Make Mike Madigan Money Plan’ had nothing to do with unions, with labor, with consensus, with community support, with constituent services or even consumer protection,”

Assistant U.S. Attorney Diane MacArthur told the jury. “This was about Mike Madigan, what he wanted, what he got.”

And, she added, Madigan barreled through repeated red flags raised by alderman-turned-FBI mole Daniel Solis, who even used the radioactive phrase “quid pro quo” in one wiretapped

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